Clare Gartz

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EDUCATION

Cornell University **Ithaca, NY**
College of Engineering | B.S. in Operations Research and Engineering | Mathematics Minor *August 2026 – May 2030*
Activities: Kappa Theta Pi (Delta Class), Cornell Data Journal (Analyst)
Coursework: Intro to ML, Multivariable Calculus, Data Science and Decision Making, Physics 1, Experimental Physics

Lake Forest Academy (LFA) **Lake Forest, IL**
GPA: 4.15/4.33 (unweighted) *August 2022 – May 2026*
Coursework: Linear Algebra, Multivariable Calculus, Statistics, Game Theory
Awards: Ainsworth Mathematics Award (highest department honor), Cum Laude Society, Mary Freeland Award, Jonathan Fremd Award, Head of School List (8 semesters), Academic Performance List (8 semesters)

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Greg's Path Forward Foundation (GPFF)
Data Analysis Intern *January 2026 – August 2026*
- Analyzed 500+ pre- and post-presentation survey scores to evaluate the effectiveness of GPFF's educational materials and to better understand diverse audiences' prior knowledge and biases about recreational drug dangers.
- Developed an interactive dashboard visualizing score distributions across 7 demographic categories, enabling the nontechnical presenters to interpret and utilize results; presented this tool to GPFF Fellows for implementation.

Mathematical Modeling for Image Classification Independent Study
Student Researcher *August 2025 – December 2025*
- Built a Python project comparing models on the MNIST handwritten-digit dataset, using linear regression as a baseline to measure how much and why logistic regression and neural networks improve accuracy (GitHub).
- Learned the mathematical concepts behind neural networks and created experiments through code to display the impact on the accuracy and confidence of the model when changing layer sizes, learning rates, and model types.

LFA Science Olympiad
Head Captain *August 2022 – June 2026*
- Led the varsity team (2nd in state in 2024) for STEM competitions at high schools and universities (UChicago, Northwestern University, UIUC) and mentored students in Wind Power, Circuit Lab, and Experimental Design.
- Specialized in the Experimental Design event (4th in state in 2024), which involved designing and executing an experiment on a given topic in physics or chemistry and creating a lab report within 50 minutes as a team of 3.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Girl Up Club
Club Leader *August 2023 – June 2026*
- Launched an annual fashion show that raised $2,500+ and partnered with 5 local female-owned businesses in 2025, then expanded to gain 5 new sponsors and an additional $700 in 2026 for the United Nations' Girl Up.

LFA Sustainability Initiative
Club Leader *August 2022 – June 2026*
- Managed food waste of 500+ people through compost, informed 600+ community members about climate issues through all-school meetings, pioneered the effort to implement reusable utensils for school events and fundraisers.

LFA Leadership
Head Prefect & Student Leader *August 2024 – June 2026*
- Elected by students and faculty to be Head Prefect, and in this role, advanced the school's mission and oversaw all student leadership teams (Student Council, Prefects, Proctors), meeting semi-monthly with the Head of School.
- Served as a representative on the Disciplinary Committee and captain of the Varsity Girls' Lacrosse Team at LFA.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Skills: Python, R, Git, Linux, LaTeX
Interests: Tennis, Lacrosse, Hiking, Travel, Playlist-Making, Matcha